

Ironhack AI consulting and Integration
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Week 2 Day 4 Lab

Lab summary and challenges experienced report:

The main challenges were API authentication and credit limitations. NewsAPI returned persistent 401 errors despite a valid key, so I implemented a mock data fallback that maintains the pipeline functionality. Anthropic Claude had insufficient credits for sentiment analysis, so I modified the summarizer to use OpenAI for both summarization and sentiment tasks, preserving the fallback architecture.

What I Learned:

This lab demonstrated practical API integration patterns including rate limiting, cost tracking, and graceful degradation. I implemented proper error handling with fallback providers and learned to track token usage across multiple LLM calls. The modular design made it easy to swap providers when needed.

Improvements:

Future iterations could add response caching to avoid reprocessing identical articles, a SQLite database for persistent storage, and async processing for concurrent article handling. The mock data system could be enhanced to support more diverse article categories.